the leak was never identified but there were strong rumours that it was from an embassy in London. In the event, both plans were released on April 7, 1943, the American plan in Washington, and the British plan in London.

THE KEYNES AND WHITE PLANS: A BRIEF OUTLINE

Keynes and White had both submitted tentative plans. They provided the outlines of an international monetary system, with a fundamental similarity in general principles and objectives, but important differences in the practical framework and technique of operation. In general, the White plan was less explicit about the fundamentals than the Keynes plan, but went more meticulously into details in regard to the constitution, management, and working of the Fund. The main objective of both the plans was the promotion of international trade through the establishment of a multilateral system of clearing, provision of credit up to prescribed limits to member countries in balance of payments difficulties, orderly changes in exchange rates, prescription of guidelines for action to restore balance of payments equilibrium, and the creation of a permanent machinery for consultation and co-operation in running the international monetary system.[6]

It would be unjustifiably tangential to the main theme of the book to discuss the two plans in detail. Suffice it to say that the main feature of the Keynes plan (of April 1943) was the establishment of an International Clearing Union based on an international currency (for book-keeping purposes only) called bancor with value fixed (but not unalterably) in terms of gold. The initial par values of currencies of member countries were to be fixed in terms of bancor, which was to be accepted by them as equivalent of gold for settling their international balances. Member countries were to be assigned a quota fixed on the basis of the value of their foreign trade in the three pre-war years. No payment was to be made by member countries by way of subscription in gold or foreign exchange towards the quota; the size of the individual quotas was intended to measure the member's responsibility in the management of the Union and set a limit to the maximum credit facility available to each member. That is to say, the Union was to have no capital of its own.

The essence of the system was that member countries were to accept in respect of currency balances due to them from other members a transfer of